

Postmortem Report of JLR Cyberattack

1. Title and Introduction

Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) Cyberattack dated 31 August 2024

2. Issue summary

On 31 August 2024, Jaguar Land Rover (**JLR**), the organisation produces about 1,000 vehicles daily, experienced a significant cyberattack that forced the British manufacturer to shut down IT system and halt manufacturing lines.

<https://cybermagazine.com/news/the-impact-of-major-cyber-attack-on-jlrs-production-lines>

- The entire IT system and product line were shut down.
- Few power plants were halt
- Sensitive information (proprietary documents, source code, and partner and employee data) leaked.

(<https://www.cyfirma.com/research/investigation-report-on-jaguar-land-rover-cyberattack/>)

- JLR has written to around 33,000 employees who were affected and supported them with emergency money.

(<https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/ckgvxqdznjqo>)

3. Timeline

Incident happened on August 31, 2025: The company described the attack as cyber incident

Discovered on 1st September 2025: JLR issues a notice of cyber incident

(<https://www.bing.com/search?g=jlr+cyber+attack+time+line&pc=EMMX04&FORM=EMMXA2&mkt=en-gb>)

Communicated to the media on 2nd September 2025 confirming that it is impacted by the cyberattack.

September 6, 2025 – The company announces that it is working with the 3rd party cybersecurity specialist and law enforcement to restore the system as soon as possible.

September 10 – JLR reveals that some data has been affected by the data breach.

September 16, 2025: JLR extended the time of its production halt till 24 Sep, 2025 (<https://www.cyfirma.com/research/investigation-report-on-jaguar-land-rover-cyberattack/>)

September 19, 2025: The company declared that the attack caused £5 to £10 million loss per day.

4. Root cause analysis

The cyber analyst pointed the attack as a global pattern (<https://etedge-insights.com/technology/cyber-security/what-the-jaguar-land-rover-cyberattack-reveals-about-digital-vulnerabilites/>). The ransomware group, HELLCAT is responsible for the earlier attack (used the Infostealer Playbook). The group stole hundreds of gigabytes of data from JLR. HELLCAT managed to attack the supply chain (3rd party) of JLR. Two of the threat actors admitted that Atlassian Jira were used to access the company's system (<https://www.securityweek.com/ransomware-group-claims-attacks-on-ascom-jaguar-land-rover/amp/?internal=true>). Long before the attack, infostealers used to extract the credentials from LG electronics employees who had access to JLR's Jira server back to 2021. The Gurdian published a news saying that English-speaking hackers are responsible for the attack as they posted screenshots on a Telegram channel (The Gurdian). Therefore, the attack was pre-planned. The hackers planned for a long time and acted step-by-step.

5. Impact and Mitigation

Data that was compromised:

- **System disruption:** The incident forced the entire IT system to shut down.
- **Supply chain impacted:** The midlands supply chain, which consists of hundreds of Tier-1 and Tier-2 suppliers, has been impacted badly. (<https://etedge-insights.com/technology/cyber-security/what-the-jaguar-land-rover-cyberattack-reveals-about-digital-vulnerabilites/>)

JLR collaborated with the **National Crime Agency (NCA)** and the **National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC)** to investigate the incident.

The affected employees were notified directly and offered support and guidance.

JLR implemented additional security measures including a Zero trust policy, immediate shut-down in case of any breach, focusing on rapid containment and response. (<https://cybermagazine.com/news/jlr-how-can-companies-avoid-a-major-cyber-attack>). JLR resumed its operation by taking the Phase Restart step. It addresses the backlogs and restores the functionality (<https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/c0q75q4187no>).

6. Contributing factors

The contributing factors of JLR cyberattack include a failure to patch a known vulnerability in SAP NetWeaver software, insufficient network segmentation between IT and Operational Technology (OT) system and use of old third-party credentials. (AI overview)

7. Resolution and recovery

Ongoing – JLR took a phase restart procedure that includes restart of manufacturing operations, communication with employees, retailers and suppliers, use of advanced monitoring system to assess network stability and at the same time flag the potential risk at the real time. It is also prioritising the safety rather than speed.

8. Corrective and preventative measures

Lessons Learned:

- **Data Security:** The incident highlighted the importance strong passwords, MFA and staff training and Zero Trust Policy.
- **Secure Active Directory:** Strengthen the identity system, for example, Active Directory in Microsoft 365. It will minimise the risk of credential theft.
- **Diversify Technology Stack:** Avoid single source dependency, diversify and segment the technology stack so that if one is attacked, the others can be safe.
- **Regular Incident Response Testing:** Perform regular test, incident scenarios to keep the staff up-to-date and check that everything is working in the system as expected.
- **Separate Supply Chain:** Separating supply chain is the best and secure practice as it will segment all other operational department apart.